

THE BAIT STATION LIBERATION GUIDE



NYC, like most cities, uses an excruciating class of poisons called anticoagulants to kill rats and mice slowly, over days or weeks of internal bleeding. The poison is deadly to the rodents themselves, and often to the animals who eat them. For all that suffering, it lowers their numbers only a little, because the population is capped mainly by territory and food, not by poison. Killing the adults only gives the survivors room to breed, so it may even mean more very young rats, fighting and starving over the same scraps.

These stations are a blight on any city that uses them. If you can legally remove the poison from one, do. This guide will show you how to open them.

1

FIELD TACTICS

read this once, then go out

Each bait station is different. Some are old and unused, some are fresh and clean and full of poison. Some are hard to open and may require A LOT of prying and elbow-grease (I'm looking at you, Protecta LP!), and some may be zip-tied to a gate. Nearly all contain something horrible. All four keys sell as one cheap pack online: search "bait station keys". You should aim to become moderately familiar with the kinds of locks you might encounter by looking through this guide, but do not make the mistake of studying overly-much when you ought to be outside, *learning by doing*.

While you have every right to remove bait that you have the legal authority to, you may at first feel a bit of wariness at actually doing so. Because of that, it may be best to remove bait at night, where there are fewer people to ask prying questions. Consider beforehand what you'll say to anyone who asks one. Perhaps you are a volunteer of some community organization, happy to clean up your neighborhood. Rather ironically, wearing a high-viz vest will make you completely invisible to most people.

It may be helpful to carry a dim flashlight to aid in your duties. To keep yourself clean, consider using (in addition to nitrile gloves) a dog poop bag so you can manipulate things without soiling even your gloved hands. The detractors of our furry friends are correct that rodents are often quite dirty, and you should avoid contact with surfaces they have touched. Put the poison directly into a trash bag, then put that bag in another. Dispose of the whole thing in a rat-proof bin, or better at a SAFE disposal event.

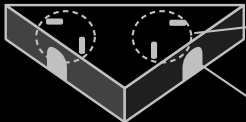
Don't be overly afraid of the poison. It's very dilute, and you'd likely need to actually EAT a lot for it to be dangerous. An exception is certain powdered poisons, but still you'd need to consume/inhale an appreciable amount for it to become worrisome. Just wash your hands well with soap and water when you come home. That said, I'm not responsible for your safety or the verification of any facts in this guide: no one is but you.

If you've read this far, now is the time to act.

2

PROTECTA LP

Bell Labs, 13 x 9 x 3³/₈ in



TWO locks
each a PAIR of slots,
so four holes in all

2-in entries
one at each end

flat triangle

lid LIFTS OFF



the hole



The 2-prong key

BRASS, tips at 90 deg

SPOT IT

The flat triangle that tucks along a wall. Two locks on the top face, four slots in all. The lid lifts clean off.

OPEN IT

- ①  Tabs face the **INSIDE** edge.
Push straight down, firm.
 - ②  Tip the key top **AWAY** from the box. That lock lets go.
 - ③  Now the second lock.
 - ④  Lift the lid straight off.
- ⑤  **Shut:** press both sides till they **CLICK**.

3

PROTECTA EVO

Express, the heavy armored one



wiggly keyhole

in the **SIDE** of the lid,
with a little U-shaped
ledge molded below.

floor-level entry
one at each end

hinged cover

very heavy



the hole



The EVO key

BLACK tab, wiggly end

SPOT IT

Chunky rounded shell with a hinged cover. It hides a concrete block, so it is heavy for its size.

OPEN IT

- ①  Match the pattern and push it straight **IN**. No turning at all.
- ②  The cover usually pops itself. If not, lever it with the key.

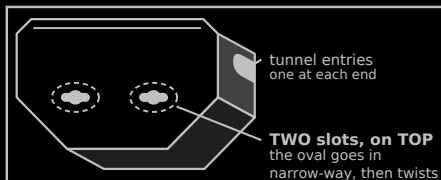


Shut: press both sides till it SNAPS.

4

AEGIS RP

Liphatech, 12 $\frac{7}{8}$ x 7 $\frac{7}{8}$ x 4 in



low box

hinge at back



The Aegis key

BLACK, plain oval tip

SPOT IT

A low box, wider at the back and only 4 inches tall. The lid is hinged and opens away from the wall.

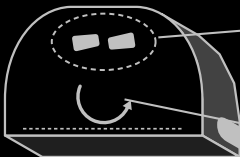
OPEN IT

- ①  Slide the oval in narrow-way.
 - ②  TWIST it. The oval spreads four spring flanges and frees the lid.
 - ③  Now the second lock.
 - ④  Swing the lid up and back.
-  **Shut: drop the lid, press till it clicks.**

5

EZ-KLEAN

VM Products, 12½ x 8¾ x 3¼ in



TWO slots, on TOP
the SAME slot twice,
turned round 30 deg

molded arrow
turn the way it points

flattest one

raised front lip



the hole



The VM key

gray fob, twin prongs

SPOT IT

The flattest box out here. One arched entry on each side, set opposite each other.

OPEN IT

- ①  Both prongs into the two slots.
Press down **HARD** and hold.
 - ②  Turn it 30 degrees, the way the
molded arrow beside it points.
 - ③  Tug it toward the **BACK**, then lift.
- ④  **Shut: press both sides till it clicks.**

6

THREE ODD ONES

none of them takes a key from the pack



B&G RODENT CAFE

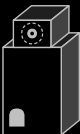
SQUARE from above, the only one out here that is. Front corners cut off, back corners round, hinged along the back. Two small slots side by side just inside the front edge.



The key is a flat two-prong fork.

Prongs in, push DOWN hard, then push the key toward the BACK. Lift the lid.

3D print your own key: see QR code on back cover



JT EATON 902

It STANDS UP. Everything else here lies flat, so that alone tells you what it is. Bait hangs on a rod inside the tube.



ONE screw, hex key COUNTERclockwise.

JT Eaton replacement part XHEXKEY-G.



TOMCAT RAT STATION

Squarish, about 6 in tall, a see-through window in the lid, and a molded living hinge.

NO KEYHOLE AT ALL.

It just opens. Some get zip-tied or screwed shut.



FINAL NOTES

GLOVES ON BEFORE YOU START

Double bag the bait before disposing of it.
Wash your hands when you are done.

SCAN THESE



NYC RAT DENSITY MAP

Find likely poison locations.



SAFE DISPOSAL EVENTS

Double bag anything you take out and bring it to a NYC SAFE Disposal Event. If you cannot, put the bagged bait in the trash.



PRINT ANOTHER COPY

Read online or print at home, with printing and folding instructions. The B&G key is there too, as a file you can 3D print.

FOR THE BETTERMENT OF ALL BEINGS THROUGHOUT THE LIGHT CONE
UNTIL THE LAST PANG OF SUFFERING HAS FOREVER FADED
AND DEATH IS NO MORE